

Setting up the project went smooth as well as getting the api key, but at some point i just couldnt connect to the mongodb cluster even though it worked earlier, i just kept getting this error 'querySrv ECONNREFUSED _mongodb._tcp.cluster0.bnag5ym.mongodb.net'. I spent a lot of time trying to troubleshoot and checked things like ip whitelisting, making sure my credentials were right, using windows network tools to ping the atlas hostnames. In the end i tried so many things and what worked was changing the connection string to the standard hardcoded format so i think there was something with my network and the dns im not 100% sure, but this works for now, the issue is if mongodb changes something in the connection string then i will have to manually change it in my env as well.

While trying to fix the connection issue, i noticed a few bugs that were unrelated, a silver lining i guess.

I also had/have issues with the usda fooddata database im using to get nutritional info from, firstly the api response structure is highly nested and each one is very long with a lot of irrelevant data, and nutrient data isnt labelled with a name, but rather ids, so i had to figure out what correlated to what and extract the relevant data from each response. The bigger issue is that the searches result in a lot of really strange foods and its really not that user friendly, you have to be very specific whn you search for something, for example u cant just search for mince or beef mince, it has to be ground beef, even searching for just beef comes up with a lot of weird stuff like ground flaxseed, the most annoying one was apple coming up with apple strudel and apple croissant and everything but an actual fruit. I combatted that issue by letting the use choose a category before searching for an ingredient and showing the 5 most relevant results which they can choose from.

Another issue i had was a very human issue in that almost everytime i referenced the food.fcdId to get the id, i wrote food.fdcId, which was a problem throughout the entire development cycle.

Going forward there is a lot I would want to do, which is most importantly making the meal cards in the browse meals page show all the information about the meal, which was something I put off doing because I was planning on changing the api i was using to a different food database called fatsecret, which i could get for free as a student, but i couldnt get the api key in time so i settled with what i was using already.

What i would do differently is use the mvc structure from the beginning, for some reason i didnt and things got messy and i had to spend quite a bit of time refactoring and solving the issues that came with that. Would much rather have just had it in the beginning....